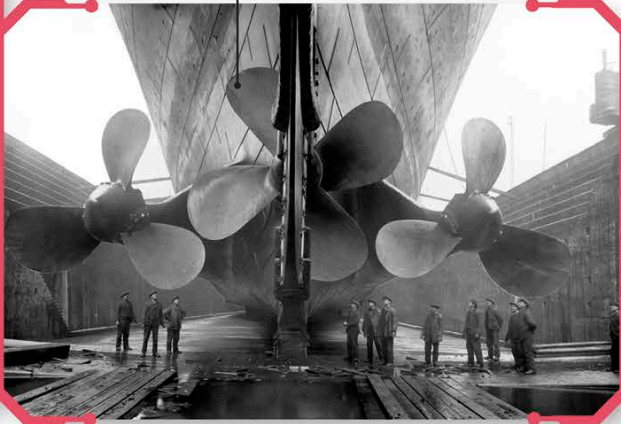


TITANIC

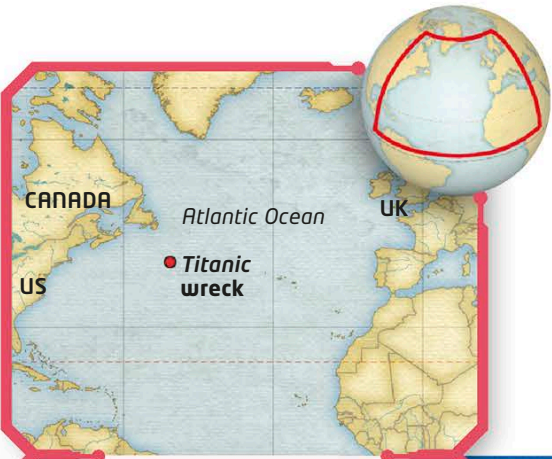
Titanic was the biggest, fastest, most luxurious cruise ship ever built—and its designers said it was the safest, too. But on its first voyage, in April 1912, the ship hit an iceberg. Three hours later, it lay at the bottom of the ocean, and more than 1,500 people had lost their lives.

Building *Titanic*

Construction of *Titanic* began in March 1909 at the Harland & Wolff shipyard in Belfast, Northern Ireland. It was the second of the White Star Line's "superships"—the first to be completed was *Titanic*'s sister ship, *Olympic* (seen here). The ships were so large that they had to be built in specially-made docks.



Three huge bronze propellers were fitted at the back of the ship to power it through the water.



The wreck site

Titanic sank on April 15, 1912, on its way from Southampton, UK, to New York, US. The wreck lies on the sea bed at a depth of 12,500 ft (3,800 m), far out at sea off the coast of Newfoundland, Canada.

Preserved by the sea

Even after more than 100 years, much of the wreck is still intact. At this depth, it is so cold and the pressure so great that most of the plants, fish, or bacteria that would normally damage a wreck cannot survive.



This porcelain bathtub is in the cabin of the captain, Edward Smith, who died in the tragedy.

The iron parts of the ship are now covered in icicle-shaped "rusticles"—a mixture of iron compounds and microbes that feed on the metal.

There is space for three crew members aboard *Nautilé*.

Finding the wreck

Titanic was only discovered in 1985, when a combined French/US expedition spotted one of the boilers. A short time later, they found the ship's bow (front), embedded in mud. Since then, submersibles like *Nautilé* have brought hundreds of items up from the deep.

